

ASIA

INDIA

Asiatic lions

The only wild lions left outside of Africa live in the dry scrublands and deciduous forests of India's Gir National Park.



Savanna trees

Although lions hunt in open grassland, a pride often gathers under shady trees during the heat of the day and climbs into branches to reach cool breezes. This vantage point also helps them spot prey animals traveling through the grasslands.

Horn of Africa

Fragmented habitats

Lions once freely roamed the savannas, grasslands, scrub, and open woodlands of the African continent, but much of their natural habitat has been lost. They are now largely limited to game reserves and national parks.

Mane

The thicker and darker a male lion's mane is, the more attractive he is to females.

Male lion



INDIAN OCEAN

Kalahari Desert

Namib Desert

Camouflage

By matching the color of the surrounding grassland of the African savanna, females can get close to prey—including targets as big as buffalo and giraffe—before giving chase.

Retractable claws

Like those of all cats, the long claws of a lion are pulled back when not in use. They are only extended when needed—such as for attacking prey.

Female lion

